



PLANES WITH PROPELLERS

For hundreds of years people tried in all sorts of crazy ways to fly like birds and insects. But it was not until 1903, when the Wright brothers attached a propeller to a small gasoline engine, that people first managed to control a plane's takeoff and landing. Today, huge jet planes can fly hundreds of people around the world, but smaller, cheaper planes with propellers are still the best form of transportation for many jobs.

These propellers have three blades. As they spin around, they move the plane forward.



Skis have been attached to the wheels so the plane can land and take off from the snow.



Fresh air!

In 1927 Charles Lindbergh made the first nonstop solo flight across the Atlantic in the *Spirit of St. Louis*. Like all pilots at that time, Lindbergh had to wear warm leather flying gear such as a helmet, gloves, a coat, and boots to protect himself from the cold.



Open cockpit



To the rescue

Light aircraft are relatively cheap to run and are ideal for transportation in large remote areas. In parts of Africa, for example, the only way doctors can get to their patients quickly is by plane.

